DAILY ROUTE PLANNING AND DISPATCH · LOGISTICS: LAST-MILE DELIVERY OPERATIONS

Route planners spend 30 minutes daily explaining changed routes.

One planner can spend 30 minutes per day explaining route changes for five drivers.

WHAT THE ROLE IS DOING

- Pulling planned and adjusted stop sequence changes from route_plans for a specific plan_id and date
- Checking stop_factors for traffic_index and customer_available, then reconciling which factor explains each changed stop
- Writing a fresh driver narrative with reordered stops, reassigned stops, delays, and next actions before dispatch

---

WHY THIS COSTS MORE THAN THE HOURS

That manual work creates inconsistent driver guidance and more back-and-forth with planners. For the last-mile route planner, the consequence is slower dispatch execution and more support tickets from confused drivers and carrier partners.

Not all of this work requires your judgment.

- **EXECUTION 50%** The execution layer retrieves changed stops, evaluates route differences, attributes likely causes such as congestion or customer unavailability, ranks factors, and formats the driver-facing message.
- **JUDGMENT 35%** The planner still interprets whether the narrative fits field conditions, decides whether added outreach is needed, and handles exceptions with drivers or carrier partners.
- **STRATEGIC 15%** Leadership still owns broader decisions about dispatch policy, carrier management, staffing structure, and route planning standards.

The execution layer is what a Decision Intelligence workflow handles. The judgment and strategic layers remain yours.

What the workflow does — step by step.

1. **Detect Changes**
   Compares the original and adjusted route plan to identify which stops changed and how they changed.

2. **Rank Causes**
   Looks up operational signals for the changed stops and ranks the factors most likely driving the adjustments.

3. **Write Narrative**
   Assembles the change summary, causal factors, and driver instructions into a plain-language route update.

Each step queries the warehouse, executes business logic, and passes structured output to the next.

What this workflow does not do.

These decisions belong to the manager.

- It does not decide whether a route should be redesigned for the day, choose which driver or carrier partner should absorb extra workload, determine whether to escalate repeated customer unavailability to account management, approve staffing or dispatch changes, or set the operating policy for how much delay is acceptable before a stop is reassigned.

The workflow's job is to get you into the meeting already holding a consistent, defensible analysis. What you do with it is yours.

What the output actually looks like.

WORKFLOW OUTPUT — SAMPLE RESPONSE

Plan P001 on 2024-06-10 shows 2 changed stops versus a normal baseline of 0 planned changes: S01 was reordered and S02 was reassigned.

1. **Traffic congestion** — 50% — S01 had a traffic_index of 120, which is above the >100 threshold used to attribute congestion-driven changes.
2. **Customer unavailability** — 50% — S02 had customer_available = FALSE, indicating the stop was affected by customer rescheduling or unavailability.

> ► Follow the updated stop sequence for S01, route S02 to the alternate driver assignment, and confirm timing with the affected customer before arrival.

Generated by the Decision Intelligence workflow against sample data.

Run your own value estimate for last-mile route planning — or talk to us about this driver communication workflow.

The Cognitive Labor Value Calculator models team size, role cost, and automation coverage to estimate the time and cost tied to manual route-change explanations. It takes under two minutes to complete.

GET IN TOUCH

DM Patterson Consulting on LinkedIn

or find us at pattersonconsultingtn.com